Just Hold Her

A Foster Mother's Memoir of Medicine, Caregiving,
and the Long Nights Together

by Judy Wright

FREE AUTHOR VISIT · READING · CONVERSATION · Q&A

They were asked to take in a baby not expected to survive.
"Would you, please... just hold her until she dies?"

They said yes.

What followed was not dramatic. It was clinical. It constant.
Diaper. Reading. Injection. Feeding.
Every two hours. Through the night. For months.

And in those ordinary days, something extraordinary too shape. Mothers organized. Pumped. Labeled. Packed coolers. More than 350 donors carried breast milk across county and state lines, even international borders for a baby they would never meet.

That child is now 17. Just Hold Her is a story about the quite work that sustains life, and what it means to keep showing up, one feeding at a time.

ABOUT THE AUTHOR

Judy Wright fostered fifty-five children over twelve years alongside her husband, John. In 2012, they were named **Michigan Foster Parents of the Year** by the Michigan Supreme Court. She is a longtime breastfeedgin advocate, La Leche League mother, and former doula. She now lives in Raleigh, North Carolina.

WHAT A VISIT INCLUDES

- 30–45 minutes — a short reading, conversation, and time for questions
- Signed copies available for attendees
- Discussion questions provided for staff education or donor engagement
- Flexible scheduling — mornings, afternoons, or evenings
- No fee. Judy volunteers her time.

CONVERSATION MAY INCLUDE

What donor milk makes possible in medically fragile infants
Caregiving at the intersection of home and hospital
How small, repeated acts sustain a life

> *"It is not a story of rescue. It is a story of witness."*

A story for those who nourish, monitor, measure, and stay — often without being seen.

To schedule a visit:

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